

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

Become a Growing Church

A Spirit-dependent Church

A free resource from JesusOnline.

Read or share online: equip.jesonline.com/channels/church/become-growing-church/a-spirit-dependent-church

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

A Spirit-dependent Church



A church demonstrates dependence on the Holy Spirit when its practices, priorities, and outcomes increasingly reflect reliance on God's power rather than human strategies, programs, or charisma alone. The results belong to God. Yet this dependence is rarely perfect; it is an ongoing journey of learning to lean on the Spirit amid weakness, failure, and the daily pressures of ministry.

Marks of a Spirit-Dependent Church

Such dependence is seen in a church that values fervent corporate prayer, regularly seeking God's direction for decisions and plans — even when human strategies still compete for attention. It appears in biblical preaching and teaching, centered on Christ, that honestly confronts sin, calls for repentance and holiness, and leads to real, though sometimes gradual, transformation in people's lives. Worship, though imperfect, carries moments of genuine passion and Christ-exalting focus. The church also makes room for spiritual gifts to build up the body and encourages believers to share the gospel with boldness — often in spite of fear or inadequacy.

Corporate dependence grows as individual believers — with all their struggles — learn to recognize the Holy Spirit’s personal ministries and cooperate with Him more consistently. He patiently teaches truth and illuminates Scripture; helps us in prayer when words fail; keeps us moving toward holiness even when we stumble; comforts us in trials; fosters peace in broken relationships; protects us from evil; guides our decisions; and empowers our service.

The clearest evidence is the growing fruit of the Spirit within the community — love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, generosity, and unity — visible not in flawless performance but in relationships that reflect grace, forgiveness, and “bearing with one another in love” through trials. Dependence on the Spirit also shows itself in the humility that admits human weakness, confesses sin quickly, and keeps returning to the Spirit for fresh filling and strength.

The Evidence of the Spirit’s Growing Fruit

Visible in relationships that reflect grace, forgiveness,
and endurance through trials.



Love • Joy • Peace • Patience • Kindness • Generosity • Unity

The Christian life is not a burden of flawless performance we must carry alone. It is Christ living His life in us and through us by the power of the Holy Spirit — bringing freedom, peace, joy, and victory even in our imperfection. By God’s grace, we walk this path one day at a time, always returning to a yielded heart through confession, faith, and obedience.



Free JesusOnline Watch → Learn → Live Resources

Capture attention immediately with a powerful video clip to introduce your message. A well-chosen video sets the emotional tone, illustrates the theme, and draws people in from the very first moment.

Deepen your content by weaving key insights from the article into your teaching. Use it as rich resource material to add credibility, fresh perspectives, and biblical connections to your sermon.

Drive lasting impact by sharing the app link at the end of your message. This simple tool helps your people review, remember, and apply the core essence of the sermon long after they leave the service.

Holy Spirit Resources

- Walking by the Spirit (PDF • Video • App)
- Power for Supernatural Living (PDF • Video • App)
- Walk in the Spirit, a video series (PDF • Video • App)
- Living by the Spirit (PDF • Video • App)
- How to Be Filled with the Holy Spirit (PDF • Video • App)

- Holy Spirit, a New Life in Christ Bible study (PDF • Video • App)

Sign up and register your church today to become a FREE JO EQUIPPED Church. →

Thank you for downloading this free resource!

We're grateful you've taken this step in your spiritual journey. Your growth in Christ encourages us, and we pray this has been a blessing—strengthening your faith, deepening your understanding of God's Word, and equipping you to live for His glory.

Share Your Thoughts

Your feedback helps us improve future resources and encourages others:

Leave a Review or Send Us a Note — If you found this helpful, please consider leaving a short review. Your honest words make a big difference! We love hearing how God is using these materials in your life.

Share Your Story → jesusonline.com/review

Discover More Free Resources

Continue growing in your walk with Jesus. Here are additional tools from the JO EQUIP library and JesusOnline Ministries:

- **Explore the Free Books** → equip.jesusonline.com/books
- **Download the Free JO App** — Your personal discipleship hub with the NET Bible, daily devotions, interactive studies, prayer tools, more books, and videos. [Download for Android](#) · [Download for iOS](#) · Explore in browser → app.jesusonline.com
- **Watch Video Playlists** → equip.jesusonline.com/playlists
- **Visit JesusOnline Ministries** — For more about this ministry and global outreach: jesusonlineministries.org

Would you like to help others? Share this resource (or the download link) with friends, your small group, or your church. Every copy planted can bear eternal fruit!

Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

Apologetics • Evangelism • Discipleship • Equipping